VTI Learning Management System Developer Brief

Thanks for your interest in building the Virtual Theological Institute new platform. We're excited to work with you on this project. Let me walk you through what we're looking for.

What We're Building

We need a modern, easy to use website with a built-in learning platform where students can take our theology courses online. Think of it as a combination of a nice informational website plus a simple LMS like Udemy or Coursera but tailored specifically for our institute.

The key thing: **students should be able to access everything easily on their phones**. Most of our audience will be using mobile devices.

The Main Website (Public Pages)

Pretty straightforward here. We need:

- **Home page** - welcoming, clear call-to-action to browse courses
- **About VTI** - who we are, our story
- **Mission & Vision** - what we stand for
- **Course Catalog** - browsable list of all available courses
- **Individual Course Pages** - detailed info about each course (syllabus, what you'll learn, instructor bio, price, enroll button)
    - **Important:** Each course page should display instructor(s) for that course with their profile picture and name as clickable elements that link to their full profile
- **Instructors/Faculty Page** - A dedicated page showing all our instructors
    - Display as a grid of profile cards with photo, name, and title/specialization
    - Clicking on any instructor opens their detailed profile page
- **Individual Instructor Profile Pages** - Full details about each instructor including:
    - Professional photo
    - Full name and credentials
    - Title/position at VTI

    - Educational background and qualifications
    - Areas of expertise/specialization
    - Bio/teaching philosophy
    - List of courses they teach (with links to those courses)
    - Contact information (if they want to share)
    - Social media links (optional)
- **Contact Page** - form + our contact details
- **FAQs** - common questions answered
- **Events & Announcements** - blog-style updates about what's happening at VTI

Must be mobile-friendly! We can't stress this enough. The site needs to look great and work smoothly on phones and tablets, not just desktops.

The Learning Platform (LMS)

This is the heart of the system. Here's how we envision it working:

For Students:

Enrollment Process:

1. Student finds a course they like
2. Fills out a registration form (name, email, phone, etc.)
3. Pays the course fee through integrated payment gateway
4. Gets automatically added to our WhatsApp group for that course
5. Receives a welcome email with login credentials and next steps

Student Dashboard:

Once logged in, students should see:

- All their enrolled courses
- Progress bars showing how far they've gotten in each course
- Quiz scores and overall performance

- Earned certificates (with download option)
- A leaderboard showing top performers (keeps things fun and competitive)
- Latest announcements from us
- Profile settings to update their info

Taking a Course:

The course player is where students actually learn. Here's how it should work:

- Courses are divided into **lessons** (could be video, text, PDF, or a mix)
- Lessons appear in order - you can't skip ahead
- After completing a lesson, there's a **quiz** (multiple choice is fine)
- Pass the quiz → next lesson unlocks automatically
- Fail the quiz → student can retry (maybe after a short delay?)
- Progress saves automatically so students can pick up where they left off

Certificates:

When a student completes all lessons and quizzes in a course:

- System automatically generates a nice PDF certificate
- Certificate includes: student name, course name, completion date, unique certificate ID
- Student can download it and share directly to WhatsApp, Facebook, or Instagram from the platform

---

Communication & Notifications

We want to stay connected with our students without being spammy.

WhatsApp Integration

- Auto-add students to relevant WhatsApp groups when they enroll
- Send automated welcome message
- Push important course updates and announcements

- (You'll need to work with WhatsApp Business API or a service like Twilio)

Email Automation

Set up automated emails for:

- Enrollment confirmation ("Welcome to the course!")
- When they complete lessons ("Great job finishing Lesson 3!")
- Certificate earned ("Congratulations! Your certificate is ready")
- New course launches
- Important announcements

We're thinking of something like Mailchimp, SendGrid, or similar for this.

Admin Panel (For VTI Staff)

We need a clean, powerful admin dashboard where we can manage everything. No instructor access needed - just admin-controlled.

What admins should be able to do:

Course Management

- Create new courses
- Upload lessons (video files, PDFs, text content)
- Organize lessons into modules/sections
- **Assign instructor(s) to each course** - ability to link one or multiple instructors to a course
- Create quizzes with multiple choice questions
- Set passing scores
- Preview courses before publishing

Instructor Management

- Add/edit/remove instructor profiles
- Upload instructor photos

- Manage instructor information (bio, credentials, courses taught, etc.)
- Control which instructors appear on which courses

Student Management

- View complete student database
- See who's enrolled in what
- Track individual student progress
- View quiz results and scores
- Export student data

Financial Management

- See all payments received
- Track refunds (more on this below)
- Export financial reports

Communication

- Post announcements that appear in student dashboards
- Send bulk emails to all students or specific courses
- Manage WhatsApp group settings

Certificates & Leaderboards

- View issued certificates
- Manage leaderboard settings
- See top performers across all courses

Course Display Features

Instructor Attribution on Course Pages:

Each course should prominently display the instructor(s) teaching it. We want this to look professional and engaging:

- Show instructor profile picture(s) in a visually appealing way (like circular avatars with a nice border)
- Display as **clickable cards/badges** that look gamified or engaging
- Think of it like achievement badges or contributor badges you see in gaming platforms
- When you hover over an instructor's image, it could show a tooltip with their name and title
- Clicking takes you to their full instructor profile page
- If multiple instructors teach the course, show them all in a row

Design inspiration: Think of how gaming platforms show "contributors" or "developers" with circular profile icons, or how social platforms display user avatars. We want it to feel modern, clean, and inviting.

The Payment & Refund System

Here's something unique about our model:

Students pay upfront to enroll → but we **refund them after they complete the course successfully**.

This keeps students motivated to finish while removing financial barriers for those who are serious about learning.

What we need:

- Integration with a reliable payment gateway (Stripe, PayPal, Razorpay, or whatever you recommend for our region)
- Automatic refund processing when a student completes a course
- Clear refund tracking in admin panel
- Receipt/invoice generation

Gamification (Keep It Fun!)

Learning should be engaging. Let's add:

- **Quiz scores** that contribute to overall course performance
- **Leaderboard** showing top students (optionally filtered by course)
- **Badges** (optional, but would be cool - like "Quick Learner", "Perfect Score", "Course Champion")
- **Gamified instructor badges** on course pages (as mentioned above)

Nothing too complex, just enough to make students feel accomplished and see their instructors as approachable.

Security & Content Protection

Our course content is valuable. We need:

- Secure video streaming (no easy download from browser)
- User authentication (students can only access courses they've enrolled in)
- SSL certificate for the entire site
- Protection against bots and automated scraping
- Secure payment processing
- Encrypted student data

Technical Stuff

We're open to your recommendations on technology stack, but here's what we need:

Hosting & Infrastructure:

- Cloud hosting (AWS, Google Cloud, DigitalOcean - whatever makes sense)
- SSL certificate
- CDN for fast content delivery worldwide
- Automated backups
- Scalable architecture (we're planning to grow!)

Must Be API-Ready:

This is important - we're planning future expansion:

- Mobile apps (iOS and Android)
- Digital library feature (more below)
- Potential integrations with other tools

So please build with a **REST API or GraphQL backend** that can support future applications without rebuilding everything.

Responsive Design:

- Mobile-first approach
- Works on all screen sizes
- Fast loading times
- Accessible (WCAG guidelines)

Future Features (Not Immediate, But Plan For)

Digital Library

We eventually want to add a resource library where students can access:

- eBooks
- PDF documents
- Video archives
- Audio lectures
- Articles and papers

Features we'll need:

- Upload and organize content
- Categories and tags
- Search and filter
- Access control (some content public, some for enrolled students only, some course-specific)

- Online reading/viewing + download options
- Bookmarking favorites

Technical requirements:

- Scalable file storage
- CDN for large files
- Metadata support
- Must integrate smoothly with existing platform

Mobile Apps

Down the road, we want native mobile apps. Your architecture should make this easy to build later without redoing the backend.

What We Need From You

Please provide a proposal that includes:

1. Timeline

- How long will this take?
- What are the major milestones?
- Can we launch in phases? (e.g., website first, then LMS features)

2. Technology Recommendations

- What stack do you suggest and why?
- What services/tools will you use for payments, emails, WhatsApp, hosting, etc.?

3. Cost Breakdown

- Development cost
- What's included vs. what's optional
- Any recurring costs we should know about (hosting, APIs, etc.)
- Maintenance and support costs after launch

4. Deliverables

Confirm you'll deliver:

- Complete website with instructor pages
- LMS platform
- Admin panel with instructor management
- Student dashboard
- WhatsApp automation
- Email automation
- Payment + refund system
- Certificate generation
- Documentation (how to use everything)
- Training for our admin team
- **Support period** (we're thinking 3-6 months of bug fixes and adjustments after launch)

5. Your Experience

- Have you built similar LMS or educational platforms?
- Can you show us examples?
- How will you handle ongoing support?

Our Expectations

Quality matters more than speed. We'd rather launch something solid than rush something buggy.

Communication is key. We want regular updates and to feel involved in the process.

Mobile-first thinking. If it doesn't work great on a phone, it doesn't work.

Scalability. Build it right so we can grow without rebuilding.

Professional yet approachable design. We want the platform to feel trustworthy and academic, but also warm and welcoming - especially the instructor profiles.